of over $10 billion: readymade garments ($15 billion); drugs and pharmaceuticals ($14.95 billion); organic and inorganic chemicals ($12.29 billion); and cotton yarn/made-ups ($11.02 billion).

While overall exports in 2019–20 were completely flat at the level of 2013–14, there were significant changes at the commodity group level.

The largest increase took place in the case of engineering goods, which saw an increase of $14.8 billion over the level of $63.9 billion in 2013–14, or about 23 per cent.

India's exports were stagnating in nominal terms as noted above. They have been declining in real terms for the past six years. As a proportion of GDP, exports were 16.9 per cent in 2013–14. They have declined continuously and steadily to 15.2 per cent in 2014–15, 12.45 per cent in 2015–16, 12.03 per cent in 2016–17, 11.46 per cent in 2017–18, 12.16 per cent in 2018–19 and 10.89 per cent in 2019–20. This has definitely hurt India's growth.

India's Imports Continue to Grow, Though at a Lower Rate

India's imports resumed their growth journey from the year 2016–17. From a tremendously high level of $490.74 billion in 2012–13, imports declined to $450.21 billion in 2013–14 and continued to do so for the next three years, bottoming out at $381.01 billion in 2015–16. Thereafter, they increased at a good clip, reaching $514.08 in 2018–19, crossing the $500 billion mark for the first time, and ended up lower at $474 billion in 2019–20.

Thirty commodities/commodity groups account for 95 per cent of India's imports. All the remaining commodities/commodity groups accounted for imports of only $22.5 billion in 2013–14 and $21.2 billion in 2019–20.

Oil and petroleum products comprise the largest segment of India's imports. Petroleum products cost India $164.8 billion in 2013–14, as much